

First, you need to identify your pen drive with *fdisk*. Plug in your pen drive and run the following command as the root user:

```
fdisk -l
```

This should show your pendrive as sdX, where X is a, b, or c... Make a note of it.

Follow this step (for *cfdisk*) only if you need to format your drive as Fat16—remember that all your data inside the pen drive will be lost:

```
cfdisk /dev/sdX
```

Choose 'Type' as 06, 'Bootable' and 'Write', followed by yes and 'Quit' to write to the partition table of the pen drive. Note that the sequence of what you need to do (as mentioned here) is important.

Slax on Pen Drive

Download the Slax 6.0.9 tar package for the USB from www.slax.org/get_slax.php. Now, carry out the following steps:

1. Double click on the Slax-6.0.9.tar package downloaded. This will open the Archive Manager and show the contents of the package, namely */boot* and */slax*. Drag and drop them onto the USB partition.
2. Open the terminal and navigate to the */boot* directory copied on the USB. You will see a shell script called *bootinst.sh*. Run the script as the root user:

```
sh bootinst.sh
```

3. That's it! You now have Slax on your pen drive!

Remarks: Very easy to install. Good selection of packages. Easy to add modules to the distro—just download the required modules from the Slax website and use the Slax Module Manager. Good hardware detection. Persistence settings.

Damn Small Linux

Download the ISO from www.damnsmalllinux.org/download.html and burn it on a CD. Boot the live CD, and plug in your pen drive. Now follow the steps given below:

1. Navigate to *Start→Apps→Tools→USB-HDD Pen Drive Install*
2. In the terminal that opens, you will be asked to answer a couple of questions:
 - Verify that your USB device is sdX. Answer 'y' if this is the correct device as shown by *fdisk* earlier.
 - The boot options will be presented next. Press *Enter* if they are acceptable.
 - Choice of keyboard: Answer 'us' for the US keyboard and press *Enter*.

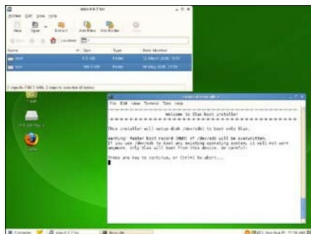


Figure 1: Installing Slax on the USB

- Following this you will be asked whether you are ready to proceed with the install. Press *Enter*. DSL will create two partitions—sdX1 (a F16 partition) and sdX2 (an ext3 partition)—and install the GRUB bootloader.

Remarks: Easy to install. Very good selection of packages. Additional packages can be downloaded by first upgrading to GNU Utilities (*Start→Apps→Tools→Upgrade to GNU Util*) and then enabling Apt. Required applications can then be downloaded from *MyDSL→My DSL Browser*. Excellent hardware detection (borrowed from Knoppix). Persistence setting can be enabled from *Start→Tools→Control Panel→Backup/Restore*, and entering sdX1 or sdX2 as the partition to save system settings in the window that opens. The only drawback is that some of the packages from repositories don't work and cause the system to freeze.

GoblinX

This is one of my favourites. Download the GoblinX-2.7.zip package for the USB from www.las.ic.unicamp.br/pub/goblinx/GoblinX-2.7/GoblinX-2.7.zip.

To install on your pen drive, follow the same steps carried out for Slax:

1. Double click on the GoblinX-2.7.zip package. This will open the Archive Manager and show the contents of the package, namely */boot* and */goblinx*. Drag and drop them onto the USB partition.
2. Open the terminal and change to the */boot* directory copied on the USB. You will see a shell script called *bootinst.sh*. Run the script as the root:

```
sh bootinst.sh
```

Remarks: Very easy to install. Excellent selection of packages. Very easy to install additional packages through Gslapt. Good hardware detection. Persistence settings. The Mini Edition has a choice of various desktops.